

ASK GANGSTA GRANNY

Born to game, she minces no words. Your gaming guru, if enlightenment you seek!

Q

Hello, the Great Gangsta Granny! I'm a girl gamer from somewhere in India. The problem I want to talk to you about is that I want to make a career in gaming. I've made that decision. I need help from you, Gangsta Granny, in ways that I could convince my parents in supporting my decision, and not be a constant hindrance. How do I do that, oh dear Granny? **—Neha**



Sweet child, it's great to see you're fighting the good fight, resolved to earn your living through gaming. I'm proud of you and I'm here to support you every step of the way.

But first, you need to tell your parents about a basic fact. What is it? Simply this – gaming is a gender neutral activity. Girls have as much chance of winning competitions with and against boys, and there's proof of some amazing girl gamers who're kicking ass in pro gaming tournaments worldwide. Checkout this epic 1v1 shootout between juliano (a girl gamer) vs kennyS (a CSGO legend) = <http://dgit.in/GirlGamerCSGO>. So it's not about skill. With practice, dedication and mentoring, a girl gamer can take out the best male players in the world.

Gaming's been picking up enormously over the past couple of years, and I've seen it with my own aging eyes. I recently participated in the ESL India Pro Gaming heats, humiliated n00b challengers left, right and centre, and I've been surprised to know just how driven young Indian gamers are in a quest to prove themselves. Follow guys like Team Brutality, Invisible Wings, Beyond Infinity – all of whom are some of the top pro gaming teams in the country. If girls like PV Sindhu, Dipa Karmakar and Sakshi Malik excel at Olympics, raise the Indian flag sky high, the same is true for competitive gaming. Indian girls can help

India achieve glory in professional gaming. Because of ESL coming to India, gaming brands like ASUS, Kingston, Gigabyte, SteelSeries, Microsoft, Sony, and others, are looking for partners and teams to sponsor. If you can find more talented gaming girls like you, perhaps you can think of pitching yourself as India's first all-girls gaming team. Wouldn't that be something? Cosplaying is another area where girls are participating in record numbers in India. Take your parents to Comic Con!

If competitive gaming isn't attractive enough for you, try studying in a dedicated game design school. It definitely isn't going to be cheap, but then you can emulate most people who are into game design and development. Hone your technical skills, or do an art course and join the gaming industry as a coder, programmer, graphics designer or an animator, whichever appeals to your whimsy. Before you enroll in any game design program, here's some rare advice: try creating simple games (using tools like GameMaker) and understand the basics of the process. The experience and learning you gain from this is invaluable, the lessons of which you'll remember forever.

Last but not least, tell your parents this isn't the 1900s anymore. The world is changing, heck India's changing, and the change is happening at an unbelievable pace. It's the same in the world of gaming. Hang in there, kid!

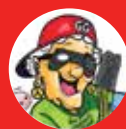
Q

Gangsta Granny, I want to know how to start a

crazy video game channel on YouTube or Twitch to stream. What are some essential points to remember? **—Rudresh**

First and foremost, Rudresh, make sure you have a content strategy in place. Fancy word, eh? But all the same, make sure you decide on what you'll be

streaming or reviewing on your channel, and think of one thing that you do that people will remember you by. Without unique appeal, some differentiator in your content, your channel won't become popular amidst the thousands



that exist on YouTube and Twitch already. So whether it involves dressing up in a gorilla mask, dubsmashing gameplay videos on Hindi movie dialogues, reviewing games in a funny Hindi dialect – whatever it may be. Find your uniqueness. On how exactly to start streaming games on Twitch or YouTube, read this article that TriggerHappy wrote: <http://www.dgit.in/CASTpro>

Want to get your gaming-related queries answered by Gangsta Granny? Write to granny@skoar.in and who knows...